

Acer Swift Edge 16

Fantastic display and performance marred by poor battery life

Manish Rajesh | manish@digit.in

The Acer Swift Edge 16 is a thin and lightweight premium laptop offering from Acer which features the new and elusive AMD Ryzen 7 7840U processor, part of AMD's mythical Phoenix lineup of CPUs.

The AMD Ryzen Phoenix chips, part of the Ryzen 7040 series, represent AMD's latest line of HS-class CPUs designed for ultrathin laptops. These processors, built on a 4nm process and based on the Zen 4 architecture, stand out with their inclusion of a dedicated AI engine called "Ryzen AI." This AI integration, influenced by AMD's acquisition of Xilinx, is a significant leap in modern CPU technology, offering AI acceleration for tasks like video conferencing enhancements and AI-based computing. With up to eight Zen 4 cores and AMD's latest RDNA 3 graphics, the Ryzen 7040 series chips promise improved performance for creators and AI workloads, challenging even Apple's latest M2 chips.

Unfortunately, the Acer Swift Edge 16 is not officially available in India, but we did get to take the laptop on a test drive and put the new CPU to the test.

Overview:

The Acer Swift Edge 16 has a deceptively large display; you wouldn't think it was



a 16-inch display if the laptop was right in front of you. It's surprisingly light and compact, weighing just 1.23Kg while being close to 13mm thick. Considering the performance we got out of this laptop during our testing, that's incredibly impressive. They weren't kidding when they said they were taking on the new 15-inch Apple MacBook Air M2 (review), which is still slightly lighter and thinner than this laptop. However, keep in mind that the Swift Edge 16 does offer a bigger display.

Build and Design

The Swift Edge 16 uses a magnesium-aluminium alloy for its lid and chassis which is lighter than aluminium only builds, but also not as sturdy. As a result, there's quite a bit of flex on the display when opening and closing the machine. This applies to the laptop base and keyboard deck as well, which can twist and flex quite easily under pressure. However, this in no way implies that the laptop is not premium. It definitely looks and feels the part.

As far as aesthetics are concerned, the laptop features a fairly subtle aes-

thetic, which looks classy and doesn't draw too much attention to itself. There are certainly more attractive looking laptops out there.

You've got a full-sized keyboard on the Swift Edge 16, which we found quite pleasant to type on. The arrow keys have been scrunched up to make room for the numpad and that can get a bit confusing at times, but the spacing between keys is otherwise great. The touchpad is precise and feels accurate; doesn't get in the way while typing. This is a non-issue if you use a secondary mouse, however, considering this is a thin and light to be used on the go, some might have preferred a slightly larger touchpad, giving the amount of space available on palm rest.

Connectivity and ports

The Swift Edge 16 has a good selection of ports for a thin and light laptop, including two USB-A ports, two USB-C ports, an HDMI 2.1 port and a microSD card reader. There's no Thunderbolt 4 port, which while unfortunate is understandable given this is an AMD chip. Other than that you have the latest WiFi 7 and Bluetooth wireless connectivity.

Coming to the webcam, the Acer Swift Edge 16 one-ups the MacBook Air by featuring a 1440p webcam. It however does not feature infrared for Windows Hello, but the laptop does come with a fingerprint sensor in the power button.

Display

The Swift Edge 16 has a fantastic display. The 16-inch 3.2K WQXGA+ OLED display is beautiful and comes with a refresh rate of 120Hz. Out of the box, the visuals looked crisp with vibrant colours and dark blacks. It didn't come as a surprise when the laptop scored 100 percent sRGB coverage and 99.3 percent DCI-P3 coverage during our display testing making it the best